PERIPHERAL DEVICES

Easy-to-Learn Assignment

Student Name: Dhwanit

Topics: Printers, scanners, webcams, connection interfaces, and setup instructions.

Learning goal: Understand what each peripheral does, how it connects to a computer, and how to set it up.

1. Types of Printers, Scanners, and Webcams

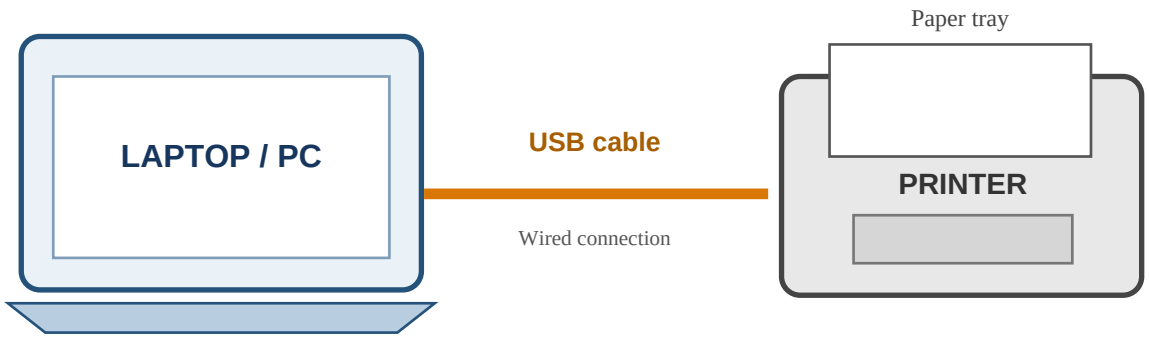
A **peripheral** is an extra device connected to a computer. It helps us print, scan, or make video calls.

Device type	Simple meaning	Real-life use case
Inkjet printer	Sprays tiny drops of ink onto paper.	Printing colourful college assignments and photos.
Laser printer	Uses toner powder and heat to print.	Printing many office documents quickly.
Thermal printer	Prints using heat on special paper.	Printing shop bills and payment receipts.
Flatbed scanner	Scans a page placed on glass.	Scanning certificates or textbook pages.
Sheet-fed scanner	Pulls pages through the scanner.	Scanning many office forms or invoices.
Built-in webcam	Camera built into a laptop.	Attending online classes on a laptop.
USB webcam	Separate camera connected by USB.	Video calls on a desktop computer.

Remember: Printers put information on paper. Scanners copy paper information into a computer. Webcams capture live video.

2. Labeled Diagram: Printer to Laptop / PC

Example: A home printer connected to a laptop with a USB cable.



Alternative: Wi-Fi connects both devices to the same home network.

USB connection: Connect the USB cable to the computer and printer. Turn the printer on, then install the driver if Windows asks for it.

Wi-Fi alternative: Connect the printer and laptop to the same home Wi-Fi network, then add the printer in the computer's printer settings. Exact menu names can vary by printer and Windows version.

Bluetooth: Some small printers support Bluetooth, but many regular home printers use USB or Wi-Fi instead.

3. Connection Interfaces: Advantages and Disadvantages

An interface is the method a device uses to communicate with a computer.

Interface	Advantage	Disadvantage	Common example
USB	Usually fast, reliable, and easy to set up.	Needs a cable and the device must be nearby.	USB webcam or printer.
Wi-Fi	No cable between the computer and device; can be shared on a network.	Needs network setup; signal problems may interrupt it.	Wireless printer or scanner.
Bluetooth	Wireless and convenient for short distances.	Usually slower than USB and not supported by every printer/scanner.	Some wireless devices and portable printers.

Quick memory trick: USB = cable, Wi-Fi = network, Bluetooth = short-range wireless.

4. How to Connect a Home Printer to a Computer

Example setup: connect a printer to a Windows laptop using a USB cable.

1. Place the printer

Put the printer on a stable table near the computer and a power socket.

2. Connect power

Plug the printer’s power cable into the socket and switch it on.

3. Connect USB

Plug one end of the USB cable into the printer and the other end into the laptop or PC.

4. Wait for detection

Wait a moment. Windows may detect and install the printer automatically.

5. Install the driver if needed

If it does not work automatically, download the correct driver from the printer maker’s official website.

6. Add the printer

Open Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Printers & scanners → Add device. Menu names may vary by Windows version.

7. Print a test page

Choose the printer in printer settings and print a test page to check that it works.

If it does not work: Check that the printer is powered on, the USB cable is firmly connected, paper is loaded, and there is no error light. Try another USB port if needed.

Short Conclusion

Printers, scanners, and webcams are useful computer peripherals. USB is a dependable wired option, Wi-Fi allows network printing without a cable, and Bluetooth is useful for supported short-range wireless devices. Following the setup instructions helps connect a device correctly.